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Week 13 Lit Example Worksheet

SHAKESPEARE: TESTING TESTIMONY

Purpose: Apply Week 13's credibility map to the witches and Brutus. Decide what each source can and cannot prove.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not retell the plot; judge source credibility.

Part 1: The Witches' Testimony

Question 1.1

What claims do the witches make about Macbeth, and which claim is soon corroborated?

Part 1 Q1

Question 1.2

Why does the corroborated claim make the witches tempting sources?

Part 1 Q2

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Part 2: Limits on the Witches' Credibility

Question 2.1

What remains uncorroborated or uncertain after Macbeth receives the Cawdor title?

Part 2 Q1

Question 2.2

Write a careful conclusion about how much Macbeth should trust the witches.

Part 2 Q2

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Part 3: Brutus as a Source

Question 3.1

What central claim does Brutus testify to about Caesar, and what access or competence does Brutus have?

Part 3 Q1

Question 3.2

What bias or pressure may affect Brutus's testimony, and what corroboration would make his claim stronger?

Part 3 Q2

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Part 4: Careful Trust Judgment

Question 4.1

Compare the witches and Brutus as sources. In one paragraph, explain why one accurate detail or one honorable speaker is not enough by itself to settle the whole question.

Part 4 Q1

Question 4.2

Choose one source from the reader and complete a credibility map: claim, source, access, bias, corroboration or conflict, and careful conclusion.

Part 4 Q2